

Chapter 140_1 - Extinguishing Fire

Chu Qingqiu's eyelashes trembled slightly. She suddenly stepped forward and wrapped her arms around Ning Fuyi's neck, hugging her tightly without saying a word.

Ning Fuyi also said no more, closing her eyes to experience the fragrance on Chu Qingqiu's body and the warmth transmitted through her clothes.

"Though the Eastern Wilderness is temporarily safe, countless demons and monsters originally trapped there have broken free from their shackles, throwing the surrounding areas into chaos. Fortunately, all sects have sent people to guard the Eastern Wilderness, barely salvaging the situation," Chu Qingqiu said with a heavy nasal tone, but it didn't affect the clarity of her words.

"The mountain fire has been controlled, but we can only move mountains to cut off the fire—the fire itself cannot be extinguished. What we fear now is that the fire seed still exists. If Infinite Ghost Fire falls on other populated and prosperous places, it will surely bring devastation to all living beings," Chu Qingqiu said.

Though she didn't express much emotion, Ning Fuyi could sense her worry.

Ning Fuyi deeply understood how terrifying Infinite Ghost Fire was. Once ignited, even if the Six Realms were destroyed, it would never be extinguished.

It seemed the person behind this had a mad heart, not hesitating even to return to Chaos themselves.

"He wants to destroy this place," Ning Fuyi said.

"If this person isn't eliminated, there will be endless future troubles," Chu Qingqiu said softly.

Ning Fuyi nodded: "But since he dares to expose himself so completely, he's determined to be an enemy of all realms. He must have methods to confront the immortal sects. And if that Emperor Tianrui is truly related to the evil spirit, his strength shouldn't be underestimated. This time, relying on you alone probably won't work—we still need to borrow the power of other immortal sects."

"I know. The day after tomorrow, all sects will come to Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate together, preparing to jointly resist Penglai Realm."

Ning Fuyi looked into Chu Qingqiu's eyes, smiled, and closed her eyes to summon Jiuying's name through the blood pact. In the next instant, the red-robed woman appeared before them, her expression also quite gloomy.

She didn't joke around and immediately said: "There's no news from Yun Ke."

Ning Fuyi was startled.

Yesterday, upon hearing about the Infinite Ghost Fire, she had guessed it was Emperor Tianrui who had acted, so she had Jiuying probe Yun Ke's whereabouts. Sure enough.

"The usual methods got no response, so we contacted other spies. It seems all our people left in Penglai Realm disappeared overnight," Jiuying said with some sadness on her face, gripping the green feather tightly.

What a Penglai Realm. Ning Fuyi's hands unconsciously dropped to her sides. She turned to look at the pitch-black cliffs in the distance, anger surging in her calm eyes.

"What about Shiqi?" Ning Fuyi suddenly turned around.

"Haven't asked yet," Jiuying said, taking out a string of bells that Baili Shiqi had left behind. She took a deep breath. "This girl has been in a daze since returning from Xuanyuan Kingdom. She left in a hurry before waiting for you. I'm afraid she might also..."

Ning Fuyi raised her chin slightly, indicating for her to shake the bells.

Whether dead or alive, they had to hear news to be certain. Although Baili Shiqi was from Penglai Realm, she had a chivalrous heart and had repeatedly saved her from danger. Naturally, Ning Fuyi was worried.

Hearing this, Jiuying released a red light from her fingertip. The red light struck the bells, producing ethereal sounds.

The bells rang for a long time. Just when the three were about to give up, a familiar voice came from the other end of the bells. Ning Fuyi let out a long sigh of relief: "Shiqi!"

"Sister Ning?" The other side paused, then lowered her voice. "Yun Ke was somehow injured and is now confined in the Mid-Air Cloud Pavilion. They say it's for quiet recuperation, but it's actually house arrest. No one is allowed to visit."

"The atmosphere in Penglai Realm is strange everywhere now. I don't know what they're doing, and I can't leave temporarily, but you don't need to worry—I won't be in danger," she said, her usually mischievous tone gone, speaking rapidly.

"Sister Ning, you must, must be careful," Baili Shiqi said. Then rustling sounds came from the other end. "Someone's coming."

With that, the rustling stopped abruptly, and the bells also stopped swaying, hanging quietly in the wind.

The three exchanged glances. Jiuying silently put away the bells, and Chu Qingqiu spoke: "What must come cannot be avoided."

Indeed, it couldn't be avoided. Ning Fuyi looked toward the dark mountain ranges in the distance, feeling strangely neither sad nor happy.

The world was about to be in great turmoil again. This moment had finally come.

The sound of bells gradually faded in the rafters. The young woman sitting by the window calmly made them as small as fingernails and inserted them into her hair full of pearls and jade.

A yellow rosewood cloud-pattern desk sat before her, with several magical artifacts placed on it, all superior immortal items. The room was bright and transparent, every object valuable. Not far away, a cloud silk cloak hung on a screen, lifted by the fragrant breeze.

The door was knocked on. A small fairy servant opened it and was about to speak when the woman interrupted.

"Where do you want me to go?" Baili Shiqi said softly.

"Penglai Great Hall," the fairy servant said with lowered head and eyes.

Baili Shiqi said nothing, slowly stood up, and took an exquisite box from the desk containing several translucent stone needles. She closed the box lid and walked out.

Penglai Great Hall wasn't far from her residence. Along the way, clouds and mist overlapped, pools gurgled, and water from the pools on both sides flowed into the ten-thousand-zhang high sky below the hall, forming waterfalls with thunderous water sounds cascading down.

This path was extremely desolate. Except for the fairy servant leading the way, no other figures could be seen. But Baili Shiqi seemed accustomed to it, walking straight up the hundred stone steps and entering the hall doors.

Emperor Tianrui was leaning sideways in a round chair, leisurely resting with closed eyes. Baili Shiqi stared at him for a moment, then suddenly broke into a smile.

"Father Emperor," she said sweetly.